

Emergency Department – General Care Guidelines

Scope of the Emergency Department (ED)

- The ED at Shifa International Hospitals provides 24/7 care for acute illness, trauma, and life-threatening conditions.
- All patients arriving by ambulance or self-presenting are registered at the ED reception desk before clinical assessment, except in immediately life-threatening cases where treatment begins first.
- The department is staffed by emergency physicians, ED nurses, and on-call specialists from Surgery, Medicine, Pediatrics, and Cardiology.

Levels of Emergency Care

- Resuscitation Bay: for cardiac arrest, severe trauma, and airway emergencies. Response time target is immediate.
- Acute Care Area: for patients needing continuous monitoring but who are not in immediate danger of death.
- Ambulatory Care Area: for minor injuries and stable, low-acuity complaints such as sprains or minor lacerations.

Standard Operating Principles

- Every patient is assessed within 10 minutes of arrival by a triage nurse (see emergency_triage.pdf for the full triage protocol).
- Vital signs (blood pressure, pulse, temperature, oxygen saturation, respiratory rate) are recorded on arrival and repeated per the acuity level.
- A consulting physician must document a clear management plan in the patient's chart before any admission or discharge decision.
- All emergency medications are administered only after verification of patient identity using two identifiers (name and MRN/CNIC).

Discharge from the ED

- Patients discharged from the ED receive written aftercare instructions and a follow-up plan.
- Any patient leaving against medical advice (LAMA) must sign a documented LAMA form after being counseled on the risks.